If I am a panna pramukh and there are about thirty names on my list, the party instructs me *ke bhaiiya sab ke ghar jaao, baat kar ke aao* [Brother, go to each one's house and talk to them], which I dutifully do. Then the party also tells me that, before the day of the voting, I should also make calls to each of these people. But there is a catch —the idea is to build a relationship and kinship. It all depends on the manner in which you approach this. Imagine if you are a panna pramukh and you start feeling important that you are in charge of twenty–twenty-five people. You go to interact with families with this in mind, normally with three–four people, and if there are ladies at home in say the afternoon, they can also get scared, that so many people have come saying press your finger on the *kamal ka phool* [lotus symbol] vote button. Do you think anyone will ever say no? They all say yes-yes, we will do it. Just appointing the panna pramukh doesn't mean that you have already won the people's hearts.

So, that is not exactly the relationship we expect. What we expect is something different. It is easy to make a phone call and just say that remember I called earlier, now please remember that the *kamal ka phool* button is the second from the bottom on the voting machine, so please press it. Nobody says to your face, if they do, it is their strength. It only works if there is a regular relationship-building. Then it means something. There is no point in becoming a panna pramukh if you are just making phone calls during election time. It has no benefit. Only if you are in regular touch and build relationships, then panna pramukh brings benefits.

The BJP has worked out very specific instructions for its booth-level workers so they can stay in touch with constituents in the manner the party wants them to.

The panna-pramukh model, which was first tried successfully in Gujarat by the BJP, was expanded to UP in the 2014 and 2019 general elections, as well as the 2017 assembly elections, and to Karnataka in the 2018 assembly elections. Typically, the BJP sorted each voter on a voting list page given to a panna pramukh into three categories: A (those who would surely vote for the BJP), B (those who may swing either way) and C (those who will vote against the